



Customised Instagram Fonts
Instagram created its own typeface called Instagram Sans. These are inspired by Instagram's Logo. <https://digit.in/jun22-37>



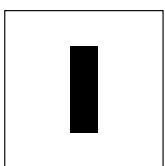
ICO orders facial data deletion
ICO ordered Clearview to delete facial recognition data of UK residents. <https://digit.in/jun22-38>

Sleep deprivation changes your ability to read faces



A new study among young adults reveals a change in the way people perceive visual social queues and facial expressions.

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It is well known that non-verbal signals and facial expressions form a big part of communication

and social interactions, at least when communicating face to face with someone. Along with aiding in social interactions, these expressions and signals help people figure out the health and emotional state of other

humans. However, for this kind of non-verbal communication to happen effectively, it is important for the people involved to look at faces for a specific amount of time, and that right there can be affected by the amount of sleep one receives.

A recent study from Uppsala University using eye-tracking technology on young adults revealed that when sleep-deprived, the ability to read expressions was hampered. For example, angry faces were evaluated as less trustworthy and healthy. The 45 participants of the study, spent one night with no sleep at all and another night with eight hours of sleep. After both nights, the movement of their eyes was tracked thanks to the eye-tracking sensor.

It was revealed that when sleep-deprived, the subjects of the experiment spent less time fixating on faces which is absolutely crucial to figuring out the emotional state of others. This can lead to an inaccu-

rate evaluation of emotional states. The study also revealed that while angry faces were perceived as less trustworthy and healthy, the neutral and fearful faces were rated less attractive and happy faces remained unaffected by sleep loss.

When it came to the amount of time spent looking at the face after sleep deprivation, the study observed that there was a drop of 6.3 to 10.6 per cent. This drop was common throughout all the test subjects and happened irrespective of the expression or emotion being shown. The study also showed a general trend toward the negative after a night without sleep where the participants were more likely to rate the faces shown, as less trustworthy or less attractive. This indicates that sleep loss is associated with a generally negative social impression of others.

Some of the things to consider with this study though is that the sample size of the participants was quite small which makes it difficult to conclusively prove the effectiveness of the study, but the results are intriguing and warrant further research. Next, we also need to consider that the participants were young adults and while the findings of the research may hold true for others in the same age bracket, it may not be valid for other age groups. This study also does not conclusively prove that the results found here may be valid for people suffering from chronic sleep loss.

OTHER EFFECTS OF SLEEP DEPRIVATION

Health Issues – Sleep is one of the most important aspects of maintaining good health. Sleep depriva-